

Zakir Sajid Elaskar

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EDUCATION

California State University, Chico

May 2026

Master of Science in Data Science and Analytics

Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune, India

June 2024

Bachelor's Program in Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Data Science graduate student with hands-on experience in Python, SQL, and machine learning, specializing in data analysis, workflow automation, and predictive modeling. Proven ability to modernize legacy systems, build reproducible pipelines, and extract insights from large-scale datasets in public health and applied analytics. Seeking Data Scientist or Data Analyst roles to drive data-driven decision-making.

EXPERIENCE

Data Science Intern, Butte County Department of Public Health

January 2026 - May 2026

- Conducted EDA on 2018–2022 cancer registry data using R, identifying colon cancer trends
- Built reproducible data cleaning and validation pipelines for efficient analysis across new datasets
- Automated data preprocessing and summary workflows to standardize and prepare datasets for analysis
- Presented findings through reports and presentations to support data-driven decision-making within the department

Research and Engagement Coordinator, First Year Experience, CSU Chico

January 2026 - May 2026

- Analysed 10 survey datasets (7 Town Hall, 3 Sense-of-Place) to evaluate student engagement and experience
- Performed data cleaning and exploratory analysis using Python (Pandas, NumPy)
- Applied thematic and directional contrast analysis to identify key patterns and insights
- Developed visualizations and reports to support program improvement and decision-making

Data Scientist Intern, California Department of Public Health

September 2025 - January 2026

- Translated legacy SAS workflows to Python, improving maintainability and reproducibility.
- Supported modernization of Enforcement & Compliance databases by processing and validating data from thousands of compliance forms dating back to approximately 2016.
- Automated data entry, cleaning, and validation workflows using Python and Power Platform, improving data quality and reducing manual effort.
- Developed analytical summaries in Excel and Power Platform to support compliance monitoring and decision-making.

RELEVANT PROJECTS

B-Line Public Transit Optimization, California State University, Chico

January 2025 - May 2026

- Analysed 134K+ ridership records and 351K+ transactions across 23 routes to identify inefficiencies in transit utilization
- Built time-series models (ARMA, GLSAR) to uncover weekly seasonality and stable demand (~168 riders/day)
- Developed regression models explaining ~88% of variance ($R^2 \approx 0.89$) highlighting key demand factors
- Identified underperforming routes operating at as low as 38% of expected demand, supporting service optimization

AutoML Pipeline for Tabular Data, California State University, Chico

March 2025 - May 2025

- Built an end-to-end AutoML pipeline for preprocessing, feature engineering, model selection, and hyperparameter tuning
- Applied pipeline across 3 classification datasets with up to 10K+ records and 30 features
- Achieved AUC ≈ 0.98 and accuracy $\approx 99\%$ using Random Forest with RFE-based feature selection
- Developed an interactive Streamlit dashboard for model comparison, feature importance, and performance evaluation

Depression Detection System, Savitribai Phule Pune University, Pune, India

June 2023 - May 2024

- Developed a multi-modal depression detection system using CNN and RNN for emotion and sentiment analysis
- Processed 28K+ facial expression samples with audio/text data for multi-modal depression detection
- Built a real-time emotion recognition pipeline using OpenCV, Haar Cascade, and TensorFlow/Keras

TECHNICAL SKILLS:

- Programming & Data Analysis: Python (Pandas, NumPy), R, SQL (MySQL), SAP, SAP Analytics
- Data Visualization & BI: Power BI, dashboards, data storytelling
- Analytics & Modeling: Regression, Time Series (ARIMA, LSTM), Anomaly Detection, Machine Learning
- Data Engineering & Quality: Data cleaning, validation, automation, reproducible workflows
- Tools & Platforms: Streamlit, Scikit-Learn, TensorFlow, Git, MS Excel

CERTIFICATIONS:

- IBM Data Analytics & Visualization (Coursera) — Python, Excel, Data Analytics, Dashboards

2025